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BUSINESS VIEWS

Sunro Copper Shipment To Japan Set for March

By GORDON BELL
Times Business Editor

First shipment of copper concentrates to Japan from the Cowichan Copper Co. Ltd.'s leased Sunro mine at Jordan River will be made next March, according to O. G. MacDonald, Cowichan president.

Bell

The shipment is initial delivery in a contract with Mitsui and Co. which calls for the entire production of the mine for the next four years.

Cowichan has a 10-year lease on the property with option to renew for two five-year periods from Consolidated Mining and Smelting. Funds to put the property into production were provided by Mitsui.

According to Mr. MacDonald revised estimates of development costs show that Cowichan will be able to mine the ore for $7.16 a ton and sell for $10.02 a ton for a net profit of $2.86 a ton based on 28 cents pound copper. The operation is expected to earn enough by the middle of 1963 to retire all debt and provide a $1 million surplus.

Mr. MacDonald also reports that both the 750-ton daily underground mill units will be in operation by the end of the year and brought up to full capacity during the first three months of 1962.

★ ★ ★

In a letter to shareholders of Cariboo Gold Quartz Mining Co. Ltd., president Dr. W. B. Burnett states that three replacement ore bodies have been discovered at its Wells gold mine.

He says that Cariboo will mine about 1,750 ounces monthly until the mine is in shape to take a definite increase.

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Speaking to a group of New York security analysts, Pacific Petroleums Ltd. president John Getgood promised the company would show a first-time profit for the year ending Feb. 28.

He added: "We expect to show an increasing profit from then on."

Revenues for the current year were estimated at about $27,000,000 compared with the previous year's $18,000,000.

Although there are no restrictions on the company to prevent further financing, Mr. Getgood said, "our present plan is to live within our means."

★ ★ ★

Fort St. John Petroleums Ltd. has reported a drop in net income to $63,601 for the year ended May 31 compared with $78,973 for the previous year.

President M. J. Walton says the drop is largely attributable to lower revenue from the Pembina field in Alberta as a result of lost production during water-flooding operations.

Increased cash flow is predicted from higher well-head prices.

★ ★ ★

Continuing its integration of subsidiary interests, Canadian Petrofina Ltd. has announced that the assets of Western Leaseholds will be acquired by Petrofina's wholly-owned subsidiary Canadian Fina Oils Ltd.

Canadian Petrofina owns 97 per cent of issued shares of Western Leaseholds and will pay independent shareholders $6.46 a share. Book value of Western was fixed at $2.79 as of June 30 this year and sold in the $3-5 range prior to the announcement.

Before the sale can be completed, shareholders will approve a merger of Western and its wholly-owned subsidiary Northern Fina Oil Ltd.

Western Leaseholds is the company created by Calgary lawyer Eric Harvie to manage the vast oil properties acquired prior to the war from British interests in lieu of legal fees. Mr. Harvey is reputed to have made a profit of more than $100 million from these lands.

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